



Gatepost Partners is building a regional **commercial kitchen hood and exhaust cleaning, grease trap, and compliance** company across **Georgia, the Carolinas, and Tennessee**, starting with a founding company doing **\$4 to \$8 million of revenue**. Owners take cash at closing, **roll equity into the combined company**, and keep their name on the truck and their crew on the routes.

INVESTMENT APPROACH

FOUNDING COMPANY

\$4mm to \$8mm

Revenue, at 15% to 22% EBITDA

PARTNER COMPANIES

\$0.5mm to \$2mm

Revenue, joining the platform

TRANSACTION

Majority Recap

Equity rolled into the platform

MANAGEMENT

A True Partnership

Encouraged to stay and grow

WHY THIS INDUSTRY



The code writes the order book

NFPA 96 sets cleaning frequency by what is cooking: monthly for solid fuel, quarterly for high volume, semiannually for casual dining.



Revenue repeats without a salesperson

Two to twelve visits per kitchen per year, on a schedule the fire marshal and the insurer both care about.



Genuinely unconsolidated

97 independent operators identified across our states, almost all single-truck or few-truck. No corporate roll-up operates in Atlanta or the Carolinas.



A real margin gap to close

Franchise units run about 15% EBITDA; route-dense operators reach 35% to 40%. Closing that gap is the whole thesis.

HOW THE PARTNERSHIP WORKS



01 The founding company

Its leaders stay on as partners. The crew and name stay.



02 Neighbors join

Adjacent operators add kitchens on the same nights.



03 Grow together

Shared scheduling, documentation, and buying power.

THE PLATFORM BRINGS

- + Chain, hotel, and institutional accounts
- + Scheduling that contracts the calendar
- + Technician pay, training, and careers
- + Back office, permits, and documentation

WHAT STAYS YOURS

- ✓ Your name and phone number
- ✓ Your crew and your routes
- ✓ A role if you want one
- ✓ Partnership equity

ACQUISITION CRITERIA

The Founding Company

- \$4mm to \$8mm of revenue
- \$600k to \$1.8mm of EBITDA
- 60%+ on scheduled frequencies
- Atlanta, Charlotte, Nashville, or Raleigh-Durham

Partner Companies

- \$0.5mm to \$2mm of revenue
- Routes adjacent to ours
- Hood, grease trap, or both
- Any of our four states

The Owner-Partner

- Ten or more years in business
- A technician-founder planning succession
- A lead tech or manager other than you
- The certification holder stays on

OUT OF SCOPE Start-ups · turnarounds · books of one-off calls · franchise territories · minority positions · a full cash exit.

TARGET SERVICES

Hood and Exhaust

- Hood, plenum, and duct to bare metal
- Rooftop and in-line fan service
- Rooftop grease containment and filters

Grease Trap and Interceptor

- Scheduled trap pumping
- In-ground interceptor service
- Line jetting, FOG manifests, cooking oil

Kitchen Safety and Compliance

- Exhaust fan repair
- Suppression inspection coordination
- Make-up air, HVAC, multi-site reporting

ABOUT OUR FOUNDER

Chris Kern founded Gatepost Partners to build a commercial kitchen safety company alongside the owners who join it. He runs a residential water treatment business, which taught him what a small service company depends on: a technician who shows up, a phone someone answers, and route density. Before that he spent several years at a lower middle market private equity firm on founder-owned platform buyouts and add-ons. He is an MBA candidate at The Wharton School and plans to run the platform day to day.